

Chronically Online

Chronically Online is a 30-minute incident-response simulation designed to train people to respond to anti-Muslim misinformation before it escalates into wider harm. The project addresses a critical problem: the speed at which hate and misinformation spreads and grows online. The simulation challenges users to make the greatest impact in the shortest possible time.

The Problem

When a false claim about a Muslim community begins spreading, accurate information often cannot catch up quickly enough. As misinformation moves across platforms, it can reach larger audiences and contribute to real-world harm.

The App

Players take on the role of a Response Coordinator in a fictional incident where a false claim about a mosque spreads across six simulated social platforms. They have 30 minutes to verify information, issue corrections, monitor the spread, and escalate qualifying content to Trust & Safety. The simulation scores four dimensions: speed, context, handover and feedback

Players must balance two live metrics: Harmful Reach and Awareness. Every action costs time and can have unintended consequences. The goal is to get accurate information ahead of harmful reach before the response window closes.

The app is a fully self-contained browser-based game built with HTML, CSS, and vanilla JavaScript, requiring no server, account, or installation.

Intended Users

The project is designed for community volunteers, response coordinators, and organizations who may be among the first to respond when harmful misinformation begins spreading.

AI Tools & Research

The game itself does not use AI during gameplay however AI was used when developing the prototype. The response framework was developed using the information provided by the Institute for Strategic Dialogue's *From Rumours to Riots* (2024).

Data, Licensing & Safety/Privacy

The simulation does not use real-world data and does not collect personal information. All content, including posts, usernames, platforms, and the Cedar Falls incident, is fictional and synthetic.